

Pediatric Sleep Hygiene & Evening Sensory Wind-Down Protocol

Circadian Rhythm Regulation for ADHD & Autism Spectrum | Framework: Pediatric Behavioral Sleep Medicine

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Clinical Resource Packet

CHILD'S NAME	AGE / GRADE	DATE	COMPLETED BY

The 90-Minute Circadian Countdown Sequence

TIME MARKER	ACTION & PHYSIOLOGICAL TRIGGER	SENSORY & ENVIRONMENTAL STRATEGY
T - 90 Min	Blue Light Cutoff (Stop Screen Time)	Melatonin suppression begins immediately under blue light. Power down all tablets, TV, and phones. Switch to warm amber lamp lighting (avoid overhead LED bulbs).
T - 60 Min	Proprioceptive Warm Bath	A warm bath 1 hour before sleep raises core temperature, followed by rapid peripheral heat dumping that signals the pineal gland to initiate sleepiness.
T - 40 Min	Deep Pressure Heavy Work	Weighted blanket (10% of body weight), gentle joint compressions, or firm bear hugs to down-regulate sympathetic nervous system arousal.
T - 20 Min	Co-Regulation Auditory Cue	Listen to a calming audiobook, soft brown noise, or parent reading aloud. Keep bedroom temperature cool (18°C-20°C / 65°F-68°F).
T - 0 Min	Lights Out & Sleep Anchor	Consistent tactile anchor (weighted toy or silk pillowcase). Ensure zero night lights directly in eye line.

Sleep Inertia Notice: Children with ADHD often struggle waking up due to delayed circadian rhythms. Place an analog sunlight simulator lamp to turn on 15 minutes before their morning alarm.